

What is Finalising?

Half-Height
Optical drives from
LITEON (17cm only),
giving more space in
cabinet for better
air circulation
and system stability.
Best for Prescott.

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Finalising is the process of closing a session on a disc. An open disk is one on which you can add data. A single-session disk has three areas: the lead-in, the program area and the lead-out. The lead-in contains the Table of Contents (ToC), the program area holds the data and the lead-out is used to pad the remaining portion of the disc with zeroes.

When the session is closed, the ToC is written to the lead-in area, which enables all CD-ROMs and CD players to read the ToC and access the data. However, the disc cannot be opened again to write more data onto it, and so the remaining space is wasted. However, if the data is written to the disc, and the session is not closed, the ToC is not written to the lead-in area; instead it's written to a separate area called the Program Memory Area (PMA).

CD recorders are capable of looking into the PMA to find the ToC of the open session,



Use the Finalise Disc option to close the session for the CD

and then continue to add more data in a new session. Thus, to make a disc multi-session, the burn process should not be finalized.

Copy protection

Copy-protection is the technology that has been devised to protect media content—be it streaming or static, from being copied. Although, it's okay to make a personal backup copy of any media for archival purposes, media companies are taking no chances and are aggressively using different copy-protection techniques to protect their content. Some popular techniques in use by game publishers are SafeDisc from Macro Vision and SecuROM from Sony. Audio CDs use Cactus Data Shield by MidBar Technologies.

SafeDisc 2 is the latest incarnation, and consists of three main features—an authenticating digital signature,

encryption that protects the content and anti-hacking software.

SecuROM is a copy-protection technique made by Sony and is employed by game publishers. The process consists of adding a unique electronic SecuROM key to the CD-ROM using special glass-mastering equipment, also manufactured by Sony DADC. The electronic key is the important element in the process. This key is not that easy to copy to a CD-R. These protection techniques can be worked around using certain copying software. CloneCD is one such one-to-one backup CD software that is commonly used.

External CD-RW 52x32x52x
Features 52x write, 32x Re-write and 52x read speed.

External Combo 52x32x52x+16x DVD
All in one CD+DVD drive featuring ultrafast 52x CD-R read/write speed, 32x re-write speed and 16x DVD read speed.

External 8x Dual DVD±RW
Supports 8x write speed on DVD+R and DVD-R, 12x DVD read speed and 40x CD-R read/write speed.

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